

THE PLAN · FOR DISCUSSION

Our robot. Our office. Demo first, then live.

We turn the strategy we already trade into a robot, prove it on a demo account, then take it live, and watch every move from our own 3D office.



01 Build the robot
our strategy, as code

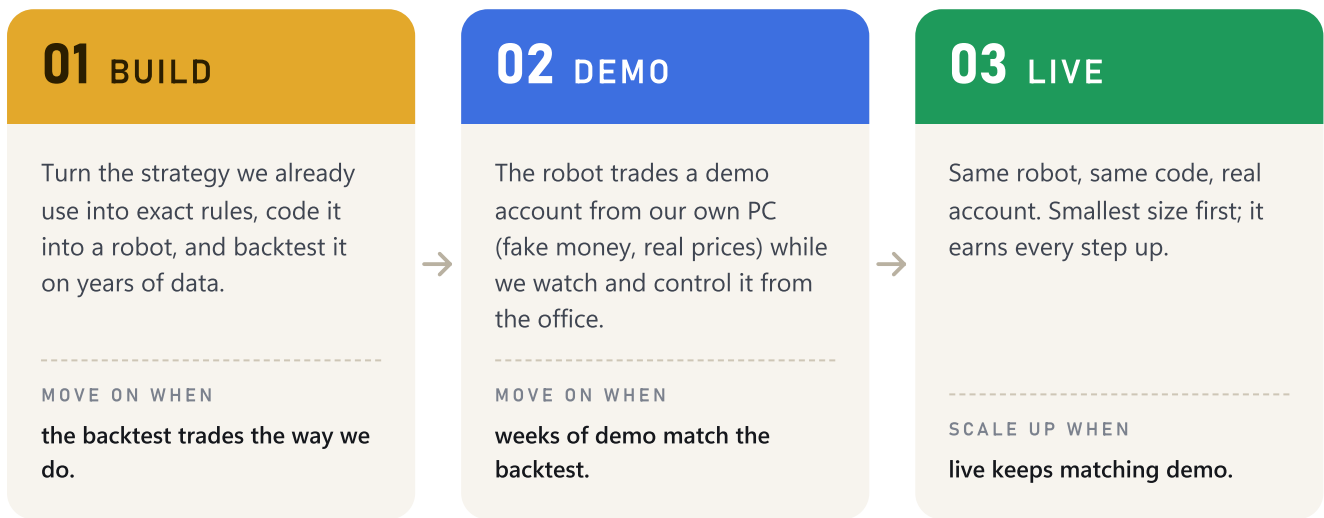
02 Demo account
fake money, real market

03 Live account
small first, then scale

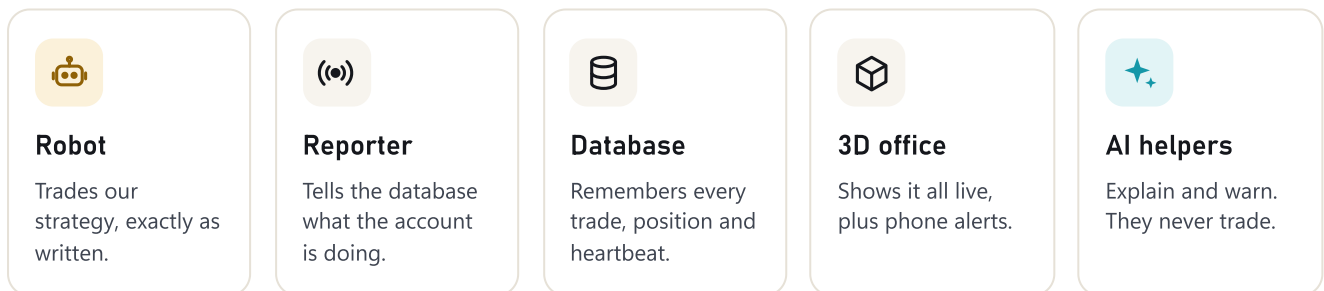
THE PLAN

Three stages. One robot. No shortcuts.

Nothing here changes how we trade. The robot follows the rules we already follow. It just never gets tired, never hesitates, and writes down every trade. Real money only comes after it has proven itself on a demo account.



What we're building five parts, and only the first one trades



DECIDED

The office watches, and gives orders.

Four buttons on every robot: Start, Pause, Done for today, Close everything. Nobody places trades from the office. It only tells a robot when to work.

[SEE PAGE 5 →](#)

WHERE WE ARE TODAY



Plan

we are here



01 Build

after page 8's questions



02 Demo

weeks, not days



03 Live

smallest size first

STAGE BY STAGE

What happens, and when we move on.

01

Build the robot

Our strategy becomes code.

WHAT HAPPENS

- Write the strategy on one page: entry, stop, exit, size, trading hours, and the days we skip (news).
- Code it with safety built in: a stop on every trade, max size, a daily loss limit, flat before the session ends, and a pause switch.
- Backtest it on several years of data.

WHAT WE NEED

- The platform: MetaTrader 5 or NinjaTrader 8
- Our rules, written down
- Historical data (comes with the platform)

WE MOVE ON WHEN

- The backtest trades like we do (win rate, average win and loss, number of trades) in good and bad periods.
- We both understand every rule.

02

Demo account

Fake money, real market.

WHAT HAPPENS

- The robot runs on our own PC, set up to stay on. For the last 1–2 weeks it moves to a VPS, so the move happens on fake money.
- A small reporter sends every trade, open position and a heartbeat (every 30 s) to our database.
- We watch it in the office, get phone alerts, and compare demo with the backtest weekly.

WHAT WE NEED

- A demo account (free)
- Our PC: no sleep, no surprise restarts
- A VPS for the final weeks (\$12–30 a month)

WE MOVE ON WHEN

- _____ weeks of demo (we pick 4–8) track the backtest.
- Every button has been tested on demo.
- The final weeks on the VPS ran without problems.
- Kill rules for live are written down (page 7).

03

Live account

Small first, then scale.

WHAT HAPPENS

- Same robot, same code. Only the account changes.
- Start at the smallest size. The office, alerts and AI reports stay exactly the same.
- A 30-minute weekly review comparing live, demo and backtest.

WHAT WE NEED

- A live account: our own capital, or a prop firm that allows robots (page 6)
- The kill rules

SCALE UP / SWITCH OFF

- Scale up when live matches demo for an agreed period.
- Switch off when any kill rule triggers. No debating it in the moment.

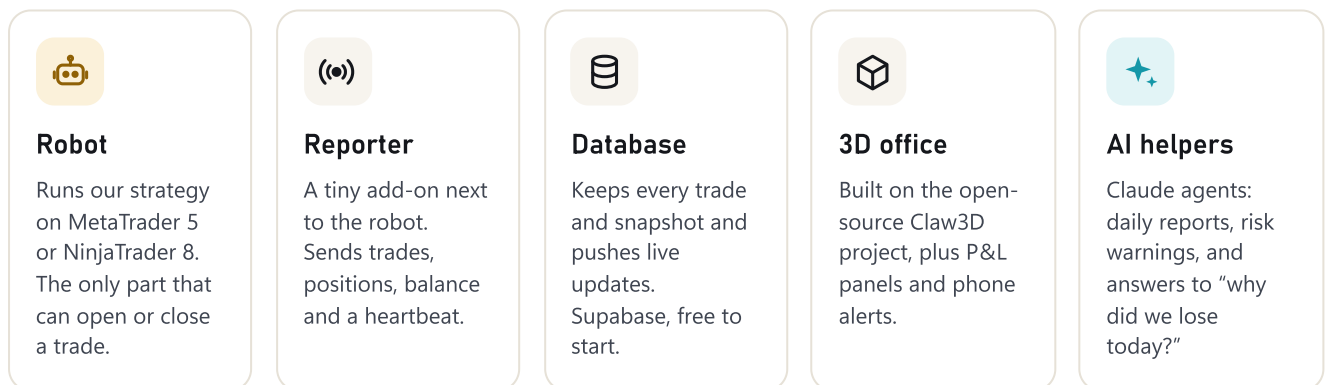
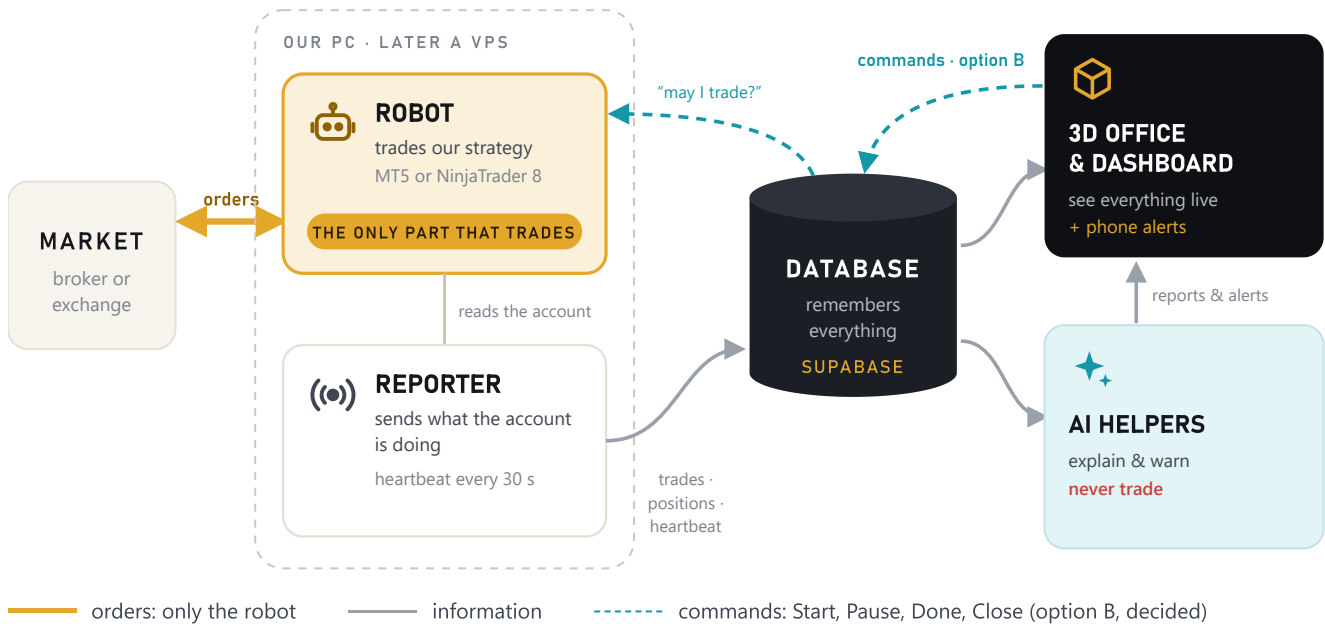


The first thing stage 01 tells us: if a rule can't be written down, a robot can't trade it. Writing the one-page rules shows us which parts of our trading are really rules, and which are gut feel.

HOW IT FITS TOGETHER

Five parts. Only one of them trades.

Every part talks to one shared database, never directly to each other. That keeps the robot simple, and makes everything around it safe to build and change.



- 1 Only the robot trades.**
Everything else reads. The most it can do is ask the robot to pause.
- 2 Everything has a heartbeat.**
If a part goes quiet for 2 minutes, we get an alert.
- 3 Passwords stay put.**
Trading logins never leave the trading computer.

Why the AI doesn't trade: in Alpha Arena (Oct–Nov 2025), AI models each traded \$10,000 of real money, and most lost. The organiser's verdict: *"LLMs can't really make money by themselves."* So our rules do the trading. The AI explains and warns.

DECIDED: OPTION B

The office watches, and gives orders.

Nobody places trades from the office. It tells a robot **when to work**, and the robot confirms every order it receives.

OPTION A · NOT CHOSEN

Watch only

The office is a window.

WE CAN

- ✓ See every robot live: at its desk means in a trade, in the lounge means waiting.
- ✓ P&L, open positions, history and health.
- ✓ Ask the AI about any robot.

WE CAN'T

- ✗ Change anything from the office. To stop a robot, we log into the VPS.

Effort **Low** Risk **Very low**

OPTION B · OUR CHOICE

Watch + command

The office is a control room.

Everything in A, plus four buttons on every robot:

Start

may take new trades

Pause

finish open trades, no new ones

Done for today

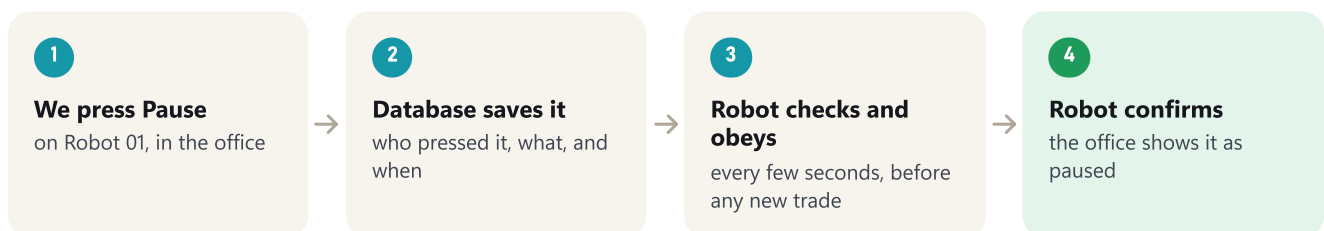
off until the next session

Close everything

flatten now · double confirm

Effort **Medium** Risk **Low, if built right**

How a command travels e.g. pausing Robot 01



✓ If the office or the internet goes down, the robot simply keeps following its own built-in rules.

Guardrails for option B

- Buttons can only start, pause, stop or close.** They can never open a trade or raise a limit.
- The robot's own limits always win** over any button.
- Every press needs a login and a confirmation**, and is logged with who and when.
- Check the venue's rules.** At Topstep, a remote "close everything" may count as sending an order.

HOW WE BUILD IT

The buttons come first. The command loop is the first thing we build, on a test robot, before the strategy exists. Every button then gets weeks of testing on demo, so by the time real money is involved, we already trust them.

WHERE WE TRADE

Where the robot trades decides what's allowed.

On our own capital, brokers generally allow robots. Prop firms each set their own rules, and some ban robots completely. We checked each firm's own rules page on 23 Sep 2026.

WHERE	ROBOTS	ON A VPS?	WHAT TO KNOW
Our own capital MetaTrader 5 · e.g. forex, gold	ALLOWED	Yes	Full control of the robot and the account. Check the broker's terms for any banned strategies. It's our own money at risk.
Lucid Trading futures · NinjaTrader, Tradovate	ALLOWED	Not stated	Robots and trade copiers are allowed. High-frequency trading and micro-scalping are banned. Accounts left untraded for 30 days are deleted.
MyFundedFutures futures	ALLOWED	Not stated	Our own automation is allowed. No high-frequency trading, and no copying other traders.
Topstep futures · TopstepX	API ONLY	No. Orders must come from our own computer.	Robots go through their API: \$29 a month, \$14.50 with their code. A server may watch and record, but it can't send orders.
Take Profit Trader futures	BANNED	n/a	Their rule #1: <i>"No Trading Bots or Algos."</i>
Apex Trader Funding futures	BANNED	n/a	<i>"No Automation or Algorithm Usage allowed."</i> Breaking it risks account closure and lost payouts.

What this means for us

On our own capital with MetaTrader 5, the plan works exactly as written. If we go the prop-firm route for futures, we **pick a firm that allows robots** (Lucid, MyFundedFutures, or Topstep's API), and never run the robot at Apex or Take Profit Trader.

Before paying for anything

Rules change often, and review sites regularly contradict the official pages. Before we buy an evaluation, we re-read that firm's own rules page, and keep a screenshot with the date.

COSTS & RULES

Cheap to run. Strict before real money.

PART	DEMO STAGE	LIVE STAGE	GOOD TO KNOW
VPS always-on Windows computer	\$0 → \$12–30	\$12–30	Demo runs on our own PC; the VPS starts in the final 1–2 weeks. Futures near Chicago: \$30–100. At Topstep the robot stays on our own PC.
Trading platform MetaTrader 5 or NinjaTrader 8	free	free	NinjaTrader's paid plans (\$99/month or \$1,499 once) only lower commissions.
Database Supabase	free	free → \$25	The free tier pauses after a week with no traffic. Our heartbeats keep it awake.
3D office Claw3D, open source (MIT)	free	free	We host it ourselves, privately.
Web hosting Vercel	free	free	Free for personal use only. Selling it to others would need a paid plan.
AI helpers Claude	a few \$	a few \$	Pay per use, and it only runs when something happens (our estimate).
Phone alerts Telegram bot	free	free	
Total per month	≈ \$0–35	≈ \$15–60	≈ \$0–5 while the robot runs on our PC. Plus capital or an evaluation fee.

Rules we agree before any real money we fill in the numbers together

1 Daily loss limit

If the day's loss reaches _____, the robot stops until tomorrow.

2 Max drawdown

Switch the robot off if we're down _____ from the peak (e.g. 1.5× its worst backtest drawdown).

3 Size steps

Start at _____. Step up only after _____ weeks of live results that match demo.

4 Hands off

We never override a trade by hand. We only pause or stop the robot.

5 Changes go through demo

Every change to the robot runs on demo first. Nothing goes straight to live.

6 Weekly review

30 minutes: live against demo against backtest. Decisions get written down.

NEXT STEPS

What we decide together, then we build.

☐	Platform	MetaTrader 5 (forex, gold) or NinjaTrader 8 (futures)?	
☐	Venue	Our own capital, or a prop firm that allows robots?	PAGE 6
☒	Office	Watch + command: Start, Pause, Done for today, Close everything.	DECIDED
☒	Where it runs	Our PC for demo, a VPS for the final weeks and for live.	DECIDED
☐	Demo	How many weeks, and which numbers mean "passed"?	PAGE 3
☐	Kill rules	Our numbers for daily loss, drawdown and size steps.	PAGE 7
☐	Who does what	Strategy rules, robot code, office, testing and reviews.	

The first two weeks

01 WEEK ONE

- Pick the platform and open a demo account.
- Fill in the strategy card: our rules on one page.
- Create the database and the phone-alert bot.

02 WEEK TWO

- All four buttons working from the phone, on a test robot.
- Alerts tested: unplug the internet, get a message.
- Robot v0 coded from the card, first backtest run.

Answer the five open questions, and we start building.

Everything in this plan starts on a demo account. Real money is the last step, not the first.

Sources, checked 23 Sep 2026: Claw3D on GitHub (github.com/iamlukethedev/Claw3D) · official rules pages of Apex Trader Funding, Take Profit Trader, MyFundedFutures, Lucid Trading and Topstep · pricing pages of Supabase, Vercel, NinjaTrader and QuantVPS · Alpha Arena Season 1 results (nof1). This is our build plan, not financial advice. Full research notes are available on request.